committed to work more closely with other Asia Pacific countries through consultations, dialogues, and joint exercises." This articulation was a break from previous governments, when India remained obsessively shy of any engagement with the United States on its "pivot" to Asia. The India–US defence relationship also received a major push with the two leaders agreeing to renew the 2005 Defence Framework Agreement for another 10 years. Their joint statement called upon both parties "to treat each other at the same level as their closest partners."[31] Unlike under the Manmohan Singh government, when military diplomacy with United States had fallen off the grid, Modi's visit helped resuscitate struggling mechanisms such as the Pol-Mil dialogue and, more importantly, the Defence Trade and Technology Initiative (DTTI). India expanded its maritime cooperation with the United States, which is evident in its commitment to upgrade the Malabar series of exercises. In his very first visit to the United States, Modi clearly filled many of the gaps left by the UPA in Indo–US relations in general and New Delhi's commitment to strategic rebalancing in particular.

In a significant gesture signalling US recognition of India's rising power, then-President Obama visited New Delhi as the chief guest of the Republic Day parade on 26 January 2015. The visit helped resolve the logjam over civilian nuclear cooperation by settling the controversial nuclear liability issue between the two countries. The two states also decided to start co-development and joint production of military equipment under the DTTI. Four pilot projects have been identified: Raven mini UAVs, mobile hybrid power source, chemical/bio protection gear, and roll on-roll off intelligence and surveillance modules for C-130J aircraft. By the end of Obama's second term, the United States had designated India as a "Major Defense Partner" – a status that puts India on a par with America's closest allies.